

Guide: Importing XLSX to SQL Server via SSMS

Step-by-step technical documentation for database administrators and data analysts

Using the SQL Server Import and Export Wizard within SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS) is the most efficient graphical method for importing Excel (.xlsx) data into a SQL Server database without writing code.

1. Prerequisites

- **Close the File:** Ensure the Excel file is completely closed to avoid data locking issues.
- **Permissions:** Verify that your SQL Server user account has INSERT and CREATE TABLE permissions on the target database.

2. Step-by-Step Import Procedure

1. **Connect to Instance:** Open SSMS and connect to your target SQL Server instance.
2. **Open Wizard:** In the Object Explorer, right-click your target database, navigate to **Tasks**, and select **Import Data...**
3. **Configure Data Source:**
 - Set the **Data Source** dropdown to Microsoft Excel.
 - Click **Browse** and select your .xlsx file path.
 - Ensure the Excel version matches your file format (e.g., Microsoft Excel 2007-2016).
 - Click **Next**.
4. **Configure Destination:**
 - Set the **Destination** dropdown to Microsoft OLE DB Provider for SQL Server (or Microsoft OLE DB Driver for SQL Server).
 - Verify the Server name and database match your current workspace.
 - Click **Next**.
5. **Specify Table Copy:** Choose Copy data from one or more tables or views and click **Next**.
6. **Map Sheets to Tables:**
 - Check the box next to the Excel sheet you want to import (e.g., Sheet1\$).
 - Under the **Destination** column, you can rename the target table name.
 - Click **Edit Mappings...** to review data types and column lengths.
7. **Execute:** Click **Next**, select Run immediately, and click **Finish** to complete the process.

3. Troubleshooting & Pro-Tips

Common Issue	Root Cause / Solution
Data Truncation Error	The wizard defaults to string lengths of 255. In the Edit Mappings dialog, increase the data type length to <code>varchar(MAX)</code> or <code>nvarchar(MAX)</code> for text-heavy columns.
Missing Provider Error	Occurs due to a 32-bit vs. 64-bit driver mismatch. Fix this by opening the 64-bit version of the wizard or installing the <i>Microsoft Access Database Engine Redistributable</i> .
Mixed Data Types	If a single column contains both numeric and text records, Excel may supply nulls for the text records. Format the column as 'Text' in Excel before running the wizard.

Important: Always inspect the final execution report inside the wizard. Even if it says "Success", check the row count to ensure all records from your spreadsheet were successfully committed to the database.